

► BUFF COAT

Date c.1640

Origin England

Material Leather

These coats were made from cowhide about 3–4mm (1/4in) thick. They provided fair protection from swords and long-range pistols. The lacing on this coat has been added for display: the original fastenings were hooks and eyes.



Skirt split at the front and back for riding



◄ TRIPLE-BARRED POT

Date c.1640

Origin England

Material Iron, leather

Troopers on both sides wore these simple helmets during the English Civil War. The two-piece skull is fitted with a neck guard – embossed to simulate lames – a pivoting peak with a barred face guard, cheekpieces, and a neck guard.

Riveted shoulder strap



◄ HARQUEBUSIER'S CUIRASS

Date c.1640

Origin England

Material Iron, leather

This simple cuirass was worn over a buff coat. The breastplate was thick – sometimes double-layered – and bulletproof. The backplate was thinner, but robust enough to resist blade thrusts in close-combat skirmishes.



▲ WHEELLOCK PISTOL

Date 17th century

Origin Italy

Military wheellock pistols were expensive and used only by cavalry. Pairs of these pistols were carried in holsters in front of the saddle. This example is more decorative than most, having mother-of-pearl inlay in the stock.



▲ MORTUARY SWORD

Date 1640

Origin England

Weight 0.89kg (2lb)

Length 92.1cm (36 1/4in)

Many mortuary swords are decorated with a chiselled portrait head amid foliage – the head supposedly of the executed King Charles I – giving the swords their name. They were used by both sides in the English Civil War.

▼ PAPPENHEIMER SWORD

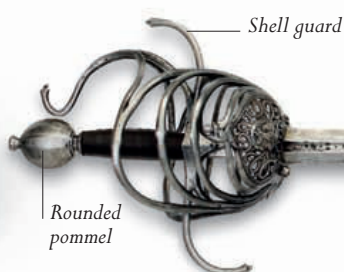
Date 1625–50

Origin Northern Europe

Weight 1.17kg (2 1/2lb)

Length 1.28m (4 1/4ft)

This style of sword was popularized by Count Pappenheim, a Bavarian field marshal in the Thirty Years' War. It is characterized by the pommel, the complex side bars, and the pierced plate or shell guard on either side of the blade.



Rapier blade